158 **‘many of my predecessors composed works in a mixed language’:** Raghavan, *Attendant Lords*, p. 71.

158–59 **‘after my birth they gave me the name of Sultan Salim’:** Thackston (trans.), *Jahangirnama*, p. 21.

159 **‘protectors for his children from the malice of his life-long enemies’:** Ibid.

159 **‘[Akbar] gives very great care and attention’:** Monserrate, *The Commentary of Father Monserrate*, p. 203.

159 **As Emperor Jahangir he would develop an appreciation:** Rogers (trans.), *Tuzuk-i-Jahangiri*, p. 141.

159 **‘was fond of Hindi songs and would occasionally compose verses’:** Ibid., p. 36.

159 **‘[Akbar] maintains, and gives a liberal education’:** Monserrate, *The Commentary of Father Monserrate*, p. 207.

159 **‘Lal Kalawant, who from his childhood had grown up in my father’s service’:** Rogers (trans.), *Tuzuk-i-Jahangiri*, p. 150.

160 **‘in his young days my father’:** Ibid., p. 17.

160 **‘He used to give them orders rather roughly’:** Ibid., p. 53.

160 **‘august voice was very resonant’:** Moosvi, *Episodes in the Life of Akbar*, p. 124.

160 **‘His table is very sumptuous, generally consisting’:** Monserrate, *The Commentary of Father Monserrate*, p. 199.

161 **the hakim (royal physician) planned each menu:** Salma Husain, *The Mughal Feast: Recipes from the Kitchen of Emperor Shah Jahan*, New Delhi: Roli Books, 2019.

161 **biryani itself was a fragrant and fortuitous Mughal mix:** Collingham, *Curry*, p. 95.

161 **included yakhni, a meat stock; musamman, stuffed roast chicken:** Taylor Sen, *Feasts and Fasts*, p. 186.

161 **Nor did the food contain kalonji, mustard seeds:** Ibid., p. 186.

162 **‘looks upon fruits as one of the greatest gifts of the Creator, and pays much attention to them’:** Ibid., p. 184.

162 **‘The food allowed to the women of the seraglio’:** Blochmann (trans.), *Ain-i Akbari*, Vol. 1, p. 59.

164 **much that remains a mystery about Fatehpur Sikri:** For some recent scholarship on the subject, see Syed Ali Nadeem Rezavi, *Fathpur Sikri Revisited*, New Delhi: Oxford University Press, 2013.

164 **‘Agra and Fatepore’, wrote Ralph Fitch:** Eraly, *The Mughal World: Life in India’s Last Golden Age*, New Delhi: Penguin Books, 2007, p. 8.

165 **‘splendour of [Akbar’s] palaces approaches closely to that’:** Monserrate, *The Commentary of Father Monserrate*, p. 199.

165 **‘in the course of fourteen or fifteen years that hill’:** Thackston (trans), *Jahangirnama*, p. 22.

165 **the Jami mosque has a triad of domes:** For a discussion on the Jami mosque, see Rezavi, *Fathpur Sikri Revisited*.

165 **‘The World is a Bridge, pass over it, but build no houses upon it’:** Husain Ahmad Khan, *Artisans, Sufis, Shrines: Colonial Architecture in Nineteenth-Century Punjab*, London: I. B. Tauris, 2015, p. 24.

165 **‘[Akbar] is so devoted to building that he sometimes quarries’:** Monserrate, *The Commentary of Father Monserrate*, p. 201.

166 **‘chains, manacles, handcuffs and other irons’:** Ibid., p. 211.

166 **‘everything cleverly fashioned elsewhere’:** Ibid.

166 **it was furnished too, with rich carpets on the floors and draperies:** Rezavi, ‘Mughal Wall Paintings’, pp. 375–402.